KEY TOPIC 3: ELIZABETHAN SOCIETY IN THE AGE OF EXPLORATION, 1558–1588

Elizabethan Society in the Age of Exploration, 1558–1588

Overarching Historical Enquiry: "How did expanding humanist education, the crisis of rural vagrancy, and audacious global voyages transform domestic society and project English power onto the world stage?"



Plate I: Governor John White discovers the deserted settlement of Roanoke Island in August 1590, finding the single word 'CROATOAN' carved upon a wooden palisade post—the enduring enigma of the 'Lost Colony'. ACCESSION: BL-1590-ROANOKE

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY SPECIFICATION CONTENT — KEY TOPIC 3 COVERAGE MATRIX

3.1 EDUCATION & LEISURE

- **Grammar schools:** 72 founded; Latin, Greek & rhetoric.
- Petty schools & dame schools; girls educated in domestic skills.
- Elite education: private tutors, universities & **Inns of Court**.
- Pastimes: noble hunting/hawking, folk football & bear-baiting.
- **The Theatre (1576):** Burbage, groundlings & Puritan civic opposition.

3.1 CHRONOLOGICAL CAUSAL FLOW

1560s: 72 Grammar Schools Endowed
↓
1571: Jesus College Oxford Founded
↓
1572: Vagabonds Act Licenses Players
↓
1576: Burbage Builds *The Theatre*

CORE DISCIPLINARY FOCUS
Humanist Schooling & Secular Theatre • *Exam: Q1 Feature / Q2 Causation*

3.2 THE PROBLEM OF THE POOR

- Population boom (2.8m to 4m), food price inflation & bad harvests.
- Agrarian change: **sheep enclosure**, rack-renting & peasant eviction.
- Social panic: Thomas Harman's **Caveat for Common Cursitors (1567)**.
- **1572 Vagabonds Act:** ear-boring & compulsory weekly poor rates.
- **1576 Poor Act:** raw materials stockpiled & Bridewells created.

3.2 CHRONOLOGICAL CAUSAL FLOW

1558–88: Population Booms to 4m
↓
1567: Harman Publishes *Caveat*
↓
1572: Ear Boring & Compulsory Rates
↓
1576: Bridewell Workhouses Mandated

CORE DISCIPLINARY FOCUS
Agrarian Crisis & Tudor Welfare • *Exam: Q1 Feature / Q3 Essay*

3.3 EXPLORATION & DISCOVERY

- Antwerp trade collapse; rise of **joint-stock companies** (Muscovy, Levant).
- Navigational tech: astrolabe, quadrant & **1569 Mercator projection**.
- Hawkins' **race-built galleons** with lower forecastles and culverins.
- Drake's 1577–80 circumnavigation; sacking of the **Cacafuego** (£400k).
- **Nova Albion (1579):** Drake's brass plate & Pacific spice trade.

3.3 CHRONOLOGICAL CAUSAL FLOW

1568: San Juan de Ulúa Ambush
↓
1569: Mercator Projection Published
↓
1579: Drake Plunders *Cacafuego*
↓
Apr 1581: Drake Knighted at Deptford

CORE DISCIPLINARY FOCUS
Scientific Navigation & Global Trade • *Exam: Q1 Feature / Q2 Causation*

3.4 RALEIGH & VIRGINIA

- Walter Raleigh's **1584 royal patent**; Amadas & Barlowe reconnaissance.
- Manteo & Wanchese brought to England; territory named Virginia.
- **1585 Lane colony:** *Tiger* grounding, lost food seeds & Wingina's murder.
- **1587 White settlement:** 117 men, women & children; Virginia Dare.
- 1588 Armada embargo delays White; 1590 discovery of **'CROATOAN'**.

3.4 CHRONOLOGICAL CAUSAL FLOW

Mar 1584: Raleigh Granted Royal Patent
↓
1585: *Tiger* Grounds; Lane at Roanoke
↓
1587: White Colony & Virginia Dare
↓
Aug 1590: White Discovers 'CROATOAN'

CORE DISCIPLINARY FOCUS
Colonial Logistics & The Lost Colony • *Exam: Q1 Feature / Q3 Essay*

ENQUIRY 1 1HI0/B4 • KEY TOPIC 3.1

Education and Leisure in Elizabethan England, 1558–1588

Historical Enquiry: How did Renaissance humanism reshape schooling and university education, and why did the emergence of the public theatre democratise popular culture?

SECTION 1 THE HUMANIST REVOLUTION: GRAMMAR SCHOOLS & SOCIAL MOBILITY

[1.1] During the reign of Elizabeth I, Renaissance humanist philosophy fundamentally transformed English attitudes toward education. Education was increasingly prized not merely for training Catholic clergymen, but as an indispensable instrument of civic duty, commercial enterprise, and effective Tudor administration. Although no universal state education system existed, opportunities expanded dramatically across the social spectrum. For young boys aged four to seven, **'petty schools'** (often conducted in private homes by literate parish dames or church clerics) provided foundational literacy in English and basic arithmetic. Bright boys from merchant, yeoman, and gentry families then progressed to grammar schools, where seventy-two new institutions were established under Elizabeth.

[1.2] The grammar school regimen was intensely demanding and rigorous. Schoolboys attended from **6:00 am to 5:30 pm** six days a week, subjected to harsh discipline and corporal punishment via the birch rod for tardiness or speaking English. The curriculum focused almost exclusively on classical languages: Latin grammar, Greek, classical literature (Cicero, Virgil, Seneca), and rhetoric. Boys memorized thousands of Latin phrases and engaged in formal debating to develop eloquence and logical reasoning.

[1.3] This educational explosion fostered a new, highly ambitious **'middling sort'** of literate citizens—yeoman farmers, merchants, attorneys, and borough aldermen. While literacy across the entire kingdom remained socially stratified (rising to roughly 30% of men in London, but remaining far lower among rural labourers), grammar schools opened pathways to social advancement based on intellectual ability rather than inherited noble blood, supplying the Crown with loyal, educated civil servants.

PRIMARY RECORD PURITAN PULPIT SERMON AGAINST THEATRES 24 August 1578

Source A: John Stockwood's Sermon at Paul's Cross, London

> *"Will not a filthy play, with the blast of a trumpet, sooner call together thousands than an hour's tolling of a bell bring a hundred to the sermon?... If you resort unto the Theatre and the Curtain, what flocking of young men and wenches, what filthy talk and wickedness is there committed! These playhouses are the sinks of all iniquity, and surely provoke the wrath of God against our city."*

Delivered by prominent Puritan preacher John Stockwood, denouncing public playhouses as sinks of moral corruption and arguing that theatrical performances provoked God into punishing London with bubonic plague.

Hinge Question: *How does Stockwood's sermon illustrate why London civic and religious authorities viewed secular public theatre as an intolerable threat to public order and Christian morality?*

SECTION 2 ELITE TUTORS, GENDER DIVIDE & THE INNS OF COURT

[2.1] Beyond grammar schools, educational opportunities mirrored the rigid hierarchy of Elizabethan gender and social rank. Girls from the nobility and wealthy gentry were educated entirely at home by private tutors. Their curriculum balanced classical languages with refined accomplishments: conversational French, Italian, needlework, lute-playing, dancing, and estate management. Queen Elizabeth herself was the supreme exemplar of the educated Renaissance woman, fluent in Latin, Greek, French, and Italian. However, for ordinary daughters of yeomen and labourers, formal schooling was virtually non-existent; girls were expected to master domestic spinning, brewing, dairy work, and childcare.

[2.2] For young gentlemen, higher education expanded rapidly. Oxford and Cambridge universities grew, with new collegiate foundations established under royal patronage, including **Jesus College, Oxford (1571)**, specifically founded to train Welsh Protestant scholars. The university curriculum moved beyond medieval scholastic theology, incorporating humanist geometry, astronomy, and Greek philosophy.

[2.3] Concurrently, thousands of sons of the landed gentry bypassed universities to attend the four **Inns of Court** in London (Gray's Inn, Lincoln's Inn, Inner Temple, Middle Temple). Here, young men studied English common law, parliamentary procedure, and political statecraft. This legal training prepared gentlemen to serve as local Justices of the Peace (JPs), county magistrates, and members of Parliament, forging an educated administrative elite that executed Crown directives across the English shires.

PRIMARY RECORD OFFICIAL SCHOOL FOUNDATION STATUTES c. 1560

Source B: Statutes of an Elizabethan Grammar School

> *"The scholars shall assemble each morning at six of the clock and depart at five of the afternoon... They shall speak no English within the schoolhouse, nor in the churchyard, nor in playing, but only Latin, on pain of the birch rod. Every scholar shall daily recite the Lord's Prayer, the Articles of the Christian Faith, and the Ten Commandments in the Latin tongue before departing."*

Statutory rules prescribing the daily routine at a grammar school: lessons starting at 6:00 am, mandatory spoken Latin conversation among pupils, daily religious prayers, and strict corporal punishment via the birch rod.

Hinge Question: *Why did Elizabethan grammar schools prioritise classical Latin rhetoric and severe corporal discipline over practical commercial or vocational instruction?*

CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY • SPECIFICATION TERMS

KT 3.1 GLOSSARY

HUMANISM
Renaissance intellectual movement emphasising classical literature, logic, and human potential.

GRAMMAR SCHOOL
Fee-paying secondary schools providing classical Latin, Greek, and rhetoric to boys of the middling sort.

GROUNDLINGS
Common theatregoers who paid one penny to stand in the open pit surrounding the thrust stage.

INNS OF COURT
Four London legal societies where young gentlemen studied English common law and statecraft.

KT 3.1 ENQUIRY STUDY DISCIPLINARY ANALYSIS

Education and Leisure in Elizabethan England, 1558–1588 (Continued)

SECTION 3 FEUDAL SPORTS & THE GRUESOME THIRST FOR BLOOD

[3.1] Elizabethan leisure pursuits reflected the stark divisions of social class while indulging an insatiable sixteenth-century appetite for violent spectacle. For the nobility and landed gentry, leisure was an exhibition of aristocratic martial prowess and refinement. Nobles engaged in deer hunting on vast private estates, hawking, formal fencing duels, and **real tennis** on indoor stone courts. Archery was compulsory by statute for all men aged sixteen to sixty on Sundays, preserving the traditional military skill of the English longbow.

[3.2] For the labouring masses, leisure was boisterous, physically punishing, and communal. Parish youths played **folk football**—unregulated, violent contests between neighbouring villages where hundreds of men battled to kick a pig's bladder to a distant landmark. With no referee, rules, or pitch boundaries, matches frequently resulted in broken limbs, gouged eyes, and fatal drownings in village rivers.

[3.3] The most popular mass entertainment across all social classes was blood sport: **bear-baiting, bull-baiting, and cock-fighting**. In Southwark, purpose-built baiting arenas holding up to 3,000 spectators pitted chained bears against packs of fierce mastiff dogs. Spectators bet vast sums on the outcomes, cheered on by crowds that included Queen Elizabeth and foreign ambassadors. The violence was viewed as exciting entertainment, reflecting a society where death and brutality were daily realities.

KEY HISTORICAL FIGURE 1531–1597



James Burbage

ACTOR, JOINER & MASTER BUILDER OF *THE THEATRE* (1576)

Pioneer of the professional English commercial theatre. He built London's first purpose-built public playhouse in Shoreditch in 1576, establishing the physical foundation for the golden age of Elizabethan drama.

DECISIVE ACTIONS:

- Secured patronage under the Earl of Leicester's Men to protect his acting company from anti-vagrant licensing laws.
- Constructed *The Theatre* outside the City of London's jurisdiction in 1576, bypassing Puritan civic bans on drama.
- Dismantled *The Theatre* in 1598, using its oak timbers to construct the world-famous *Globe Theatre* on Bankside.

SECTION 4 THE RISE OF THE PUBLIC PLAYHOUSE: FROM INN-YARDS TO BANKSIDE

[4.1] The crowning cultural achievement of the Elizabethan age was the rapid development of the secular **commercial theatre**. Previously, wandering troupes of actors performed religious mystery plays in tavern inn-yards. However, the Elizabethan regime strictly policed travelling actors: the 1572 Vagabonds Act classified unlicensed actors as common rogues, requiring theatrical companies to obtain formal licenses from noble patrons, creating celebrated companies like the Earl of Leicester's Men and the Lord Chamberlain's Men.

[4.2] Puritan civic authorities in the City of London bitterly opposed theatrical performances, condemning them as breeding grounds for pickpockets, drunkenness, prostitution, and bubonic plague transmission. To escape the Lord Mayor's jurisdiction, actor and master joiner **James Burbage** built London's first permanent commercial playhouse, ***The Theatre***, in Shoreditch in 1576. Success led to the construction of *The Curtain* (1577), *The Rose* (1587), *The Swan* (1595), and Burbage's iconic ***Globe Theatre* (1599)** on Bankside.

[4.3] Playhouses were revolutionary democratic spaces that brought together disparate social classes into a shared cultural experience. For a single copper penny, common **'groundlings'** stood in the open-air pit around the thrust stage; for twopence or threepence, affluent merchants and gentry sat in covered, cushioned galleries. Featuring the brilliant, dramatic masterpieces of Christopher Marlowe and William Shakespeare, the theatre projected English patriotic identity, reinforced Tudor political legitimacy, and created a vibrant national mythology.

CORE STRATEGIC MECHANISM POPULAR CULTURE • 1576–1599

The Architecture of the Elizabethan Playhouse

Built in polygonal open-air timber frames holding up to 3,000 spectators, playhouses democratized English culture across classes:

- **Cross-Class Assembly:** 'Groundlings' paid one penny to stand in the uncovered central pit, while affluent merchants and nobles paid twopence or threepence for tiered, roofed gallery seats.
- **Staging & Symbolism:** A large thrust stage featured a trapdoor ('Hell') for apparitions, a rear discovery space, and a painted roof canopy ('The Heavens') equipped with pulleys for descending gods.
- **Puritan Civic Anxiety:** London's Puritan magistrates condemned playhouses as hotbeds of sin, crime, Catholic allegory, and plague transmission, forcing theatres into suburban liberties like Southwark.

Strategic Legacy: The theatre created a shared secular national consciousness, celebrating Tudor political order while reflecting the anxieties and aspirations of an expanding empire.

KEY CHRONOLOGY • FOUR CAUSAL TURNING POINTS KT 3.1 SEQUENCE

c. 1560s • Expansion of Grammar Schools
Boom in fee-paying grammar schools teaching Latin, rhetoric, and classical literature to boys.

1572 • Vagabonds & Actors Act
Acting troupes required aristocratic patronage (e.g. Leicester's Men) to avoid arrest as vagabonds.

1576 • Burbage Builds *The Theatre*
First permanent public playhouse opens in Shoreditch, outside London's Puritan civic boundaries.

1599 • Construction of *The Globe*
Timbers of The Theatre dismantled and reassembled on Bankside; London theatre becomes global cultural phenomenon.

EXAM STRATEGY • EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (OPTION B4) Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins]

Exam Challenge: Explain why education expanded in Elizabethan England. [12 marks]

Specification Stimulus: (1) Grammar schools • (2) Humanist ideas • *Construct 3 PEEL paragraphs using precise factual evidence.* GRADE 9 STANDARD

ENQUIRY 2 1HI0/B4 • KEY TOPIC 3.2

The Problem of the Poor and Vagrancy, 1558–1588

Historical Enquiry: Why did rural pauperism reach unprecedented crisis levels under Elizabeth, and how did state legislation transition from brutal punishment to structured social welfare?

SECTION 1 THE DEMOGRAPHIC TIDAL WAVE: POPULATION, INFLATION & HARVEST FAILURE

[1.1] Throughout the Elizabethan era, England experienced an unprecedented crisis of poverty and vagrancy, driven by systemic economic forces beyond the control of ordinary peasants. The foundational driver was an explosive demographic expansion: England's population surged by over **35%**, growing from approximately 2.8 million in 1558 to over 4 million by 1603. Because agricultural productivity remained bound to medieval techniques, the food supply failed to keep pace with soaring consumer demand.

[1.2] As a direct consequence, food prices skyrocketed: grain prices more than doubled, triggering a catastrophic cost-of-living crisis. Ordinary farm labourers, whose wages remained virtually stagnant, saw their real purchasing power collapse by up to 50%. This structural inflation was exacerbated by Henry VIII's earlier **debasement of the coinage**, which had permanently damaged the international purchasing power of English money.

[1.3] Compounding this misery was a devastating sequence of **bad harvests** throughout the 1570s and 1580s, culminating in widespread rural starvation. Simultaneously, the European wool and cloth market collapsed: when war erupted in the Spanish Netherlands, the traditional export route through Antwerp was paralyzed, throwing thousands of English cloth workers, carders, and weavers out of work and into absolute destitution.

PRIMARY RECORD SOCIAL INVESTIGATION & TAXONOMY OF VAGRANCY 1567

Source A: Thomas Harman's A Caveat for Common Cursitors

> *"The Counterfeit Crank is a rogue that feigneth himself to have the falling sickness... These men will rub their faces with fresh blood from a sheep or bullock, and put a piece of soap into their mouths to make foam, wallowing in the dirt and crying out piteously to deceive honest people of their money. When night comes, they meet at hedge taverns and spend their alms in riot and drunkenness."*

From Harman's wildly popular pamphlet detailing the tricks of vagabonds, warning honest citizens against 'Counterfeit Cranks' who rubbed soap into their mouths to produce foam and feign epileptic fits to extract charitable alms.

Hinge Question: *How does Harman's sensational account reveal why the Elizabethan landed gentry viewed roaming vagabonds not as victims of poverty, but as an organised criminal conspiracy?*

SECTION 2 AGRARIAN UPHEAVAL: ENCLOSURE, RACK-RENTING & RURAL EVICTIONS

[2.1] These macroeconomic pressures were dramatically intensified in the countryside by the spread of agrarian **enclosure**. Traditional medieval agriculture relied on the open-field system, where peasant farmers cultivated scattered arable strips and shared common pasture land to graze their animals. In the sixteenth century, landed gentry and ambitious yeomen increasingly enclosed these lands with hedges and fences, consolidating holdings into large private estates.

[2.2] Crucially, landlords converted arable crop farming into lucrative **sheep pasture**. Wool was substantially more profitable than cereal grain and required almost no manual labour: a single shepherd and his dogs could manage a flock of 2,000 sheep on land that had previously provided livelihoods and food for dozens of peasant tenant families. Common waste land was privatised, stripping poor cottagers of vital grazing and firewood rights.

[2.3] Furthermore, landlords engaged in ruthless **'rack-renting'**—drastically hiking rents and entry fines to evict customary tenants who could not pay. Evicted families were cast adrift from their ancestral villages. Deprived of land and employment, thousands of desperate men, women, and children were forced to wander the highways as homeless 'vagabonds', drifting into overcrowded slums in London, Norwich, and Bristol in search of bread.

PRIMARY RECORD ENACTED PARLIAMENTARY STATUTE (14 ELIZ. 1 C. 5) June 1572

Source B: The 1572 Act for the Punishment of Vagabonds

> *"Every person that shall be declared a rogue, vagabond, or sturdy beggar, shall upon conviction be grievously whipped and burned through the gristle of the right ear with a hot iron of the compass of an inch... And the Justices of the Peace shall survey all aged, impotent, and lame persons within their divisions, and tax and assess all inhabitants to a weekly payment for their sustenance."*

The landmark statute establishing severe corporal punishment for rogues and vagrants (whipped and bored through the gristle of the right ear with a hot iron), while legally obliging local Justices of the Peace to collect compulsory weekly poor rates.

Hinge Question: *Why did the Elizabethan state simultaneously deploy brutal physical mutilation against vagrants while establishing the principle of compulsory public taxation to relieve the impotent poor?*

CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY • SPECIFICATION TERMS

KT 3.2 GLOSSARY

ENCLOSURE
Fencing off open communal fields and wastes, converting arable farming into lucrative sheep pasture.

RACK-RENTING
Landlords aggressively hiking rents on peasant tenants, forcing impoverished families into vagrancy.

IMPOTENT POOR
Paupers physically incapable of work (the aged, sick, lame, and orphans), deemed deserving of relief.

HOUSE OF CORRECTION
Workhouses (Bridewells) established under the 1576 Act to provide forced labour for the able-bodied idle.

KT 3.2 ENQUIRY STUDY DISCIPLINARY ANALYSIS

The Problem of the Poor and Vagrancy, 1558–1588 (Continued)

SECTION 3 THE PANIC OVER THE UNDESERVING: HARMAN'S ROGUES & COUNTERFEIT CRANKS

[3.1] To Elizabethan authorities, the sudden appearance of wandering paupers was not merely a tragic economic problem, but an existential threat to public order, property, and the **Great Chain of Being**. Rural communities lived in terror of wandering vagrant bands who might spread plague, steal livestock, or spark peasant rebellion. Elizabethan society drew a rigid moral divide between the **'Deserving' or 'Impotent Poor'** (the aged, sick, lame, and orphans physically incapable of work) and the **'Undeserving' or 'Idle Poor'** (able-bodied vagrants viewed as lazy, dishonest rogues).

[3.2] This public panic was inflamed by sensationalist popular literature, most famously Thomas Harman's 1567 pamphlet ***A Caveat or Warning for Common Cursitors***. Harman claimed that vagabonds belonged to an organized criminal underworld with its own secret slang ('canting'). He documented 23 distinct types of fraudulent beggars, warning of *'Counterfeit Cranks'* who rubbed soap into their mouths to feign epileptic fits, and *'Hookers'* who carried long poles to hook clothes through open windows at night.

[3.3] While modern historians recognize that the vast majority of vagrants were simply desperate, starving labourers seeking employment, Harman's sensational tales convinced Parliament and local magistrates that vagrancy was an organized moral conspiracy that required ferocious state repression.

KEY HISTORICAL FIGURE c. 1510–1572



Thomas Harman

KENT MAGISTRATE & SOCIAL PAMPHLETEER

Author of the sensational 1567 pamphlet *A Caveat or Warning for Common Cursitors*. His vivid taxonomy of dishonest rogues inflamed Tudor public panic over vagrancy and influenced statutory poor relief legislation.

DECISIVE ACTIONS:

- Interrogated dozens of vagrants passing through his Kent estate to document their slang ('canting') and criminal tricks.
- Categorised beggars into 23 distinct types, including 'Counterfeit Cranks' (fake epileptics) and 'Hookers' (thieves).
- Dedicated his work to the Countess of Shrewsbury, urging magistrates to adopt severe corporal punishment for the 'idle'.

SECTION 4 FROM BRUTAL MUTILATION TO STATE WELFARE: THE ACTS OF 1572 & 1576

[4.1] Confronted by escalating social unrest, Parliament pioneered a revolutionary legislative framework. Local municipal experiments in Norwich, Ipswich, and London provided the blueprint for national statutes. The landmark **1572 Vagabonds Act** established a dual approach of savage punishment and statutory taxation. For the able-bodied vagrant, penalties were brutal: a first offence brought severe public whipping and having a hole **bored through the gristle of the right ear with a hot iron** of one inch diameter. A second offence was treated as felony; a third brought hanging.

[4.2] Crucially, however, the 1572 Act recognized state responsibility for the helpless: it legally mandated that local Justices of the Peace register the impotent poor and collect a **compulsory weekly poor rate** from all property owners. Any citizen refusing to pay was imprisoned. This transformed poor relief from voluntary Christian charity into mandatory public taxation.

[4.3] The revolutionary follow-up was the **1576 Act for the Relief of the Poor**, which introduced rehabilitation and state-provided labour. Towns and parishes were ordered to stockpile raw materials—wool, hemp, flax, and iron—to provide paid employment for the able-bodied poor. Furthermore, magistrates were required to build **'Houses of Correction' (Bridewells)** in every county, where vagrants who refused to work were incarcerated and subjected to hard forced labour. Together, the Acts of 1572 and 1576 created the enduring foundation for the famous Elizabethan Poor Law of 1601.

CORE STRATEGIC MECHANISM SOCIAL LEGISLATION • 1572–76

Impotent vs. Idle: The Tudor Welfare Divide

The decisive evolution in Elizabethan social policy was distinguishing misfortune from moral deviance:

- **The Impotent (Deserving) Poor:** Those physically unable to work (the aged, sick, lame, and orphans) were granted parish licenses to beg and regular financial relief funded by mandatory local rates.
- **The Idle (Undeserving) Poor:** Able-bodied vagrants who refused work were viewed as dangerous criminals, subject to whipping, ear boring (1572 Act), and execution for repeat offences.
- **Rehabilitation & Work:** The 1576 Act ordered towns to stockpile wool, hemp, and flax to put the able-bodied to work, establishing 'Houses of Correction' (Bridewells) to discipline the recalcitrant.

Strategic Legacy: The Acts of 1572 and 1576 established the enduring constitutional principle that the secular state was legally responsible for administering nationwide poor relief.

KEY CHRONOLOGY • FOUR CAUSAL TURNING POINTS KT 3.2 SEQUENCE

1560s • Enclosure & Population Surge
Arable land converted to sheep pasture; population rises to 4 million, causing severe rural underemployment.

1567 • Harman's *Caveat for Cursitors*
Magistrate Thomas Harman publishes sensational taxonomy of fake beggars, inflaming public panic.

1572 • Vagabonds Act (Rates & Ear Boring)
Statute introduces compulsory poor rates for impotent poor; vagabonds whipped and bored through the ear.

1576 • Act for Relief of the Poor
Parishes provide raw wool and hemp for the able-bodied; Houses of Correction (Bridewells) built.

EXAM STRATEGY • EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (OPTION B4) Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

Exam Challenge: "The main reason for the increase in poverty in Elizabethan England was bad harvests." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

Specification Stimulus: (1) Enclosure of land • (2) Population growth • *Construct 3 PEEL paragraphs using precise factual evidence.* GRADE 9 STANDARD

ENQUIRY 3 1HI0/B4 • KEY TOPIC 3.3

Exploration and Voyages of Discovery, 1558–1588

Historical Enquiry: How did navigational innovations and commercial rivalry shatter Iberian dominance and inspire Drake's historic circumnavigation of the globe?

SECTION 1 THE COMMERCIAL IMPERATIVE: JOINT-STOCK TRADE & THE IBERIAN MONOPOLY

[1.1] Elizabethan voyages of oceanic discovery were born out of urgent commercial crisis, technological curiosity, and intense patriotic rivalry. For decades, English prosperity had rested dangerously upon a single economic pillar: the export of unfinished woolen cloth through the great market of Antwerp. When the Dutch Revolt and Spanish embargoes paralyzed the Antwerp trade in the 1560s, English merchant adventurers faced catastrophic ruin. English merchants were compelled to establish direct maritime trade routes to Russia, the Mediterranean, Africa, and the Far East.

[1.2] To finance these perilous oceanic ventures, Elizabethan merchants pioneered the **joint-stock company**. Rather than individual traders risking total bankruptcy, investors pooled their capital to fund voyages, sharing potential profits and limiting individual liability in proportion to their investment. The Crown granted royal charters conferring trade monopolies: the **Muscovy Company (1555)** secured Russian furs and timber; the **Eastland Company (1579)** controlled Baltic naval stores; and the **Levant Company (1581)** traded English cloth for luxury Ottoman silks and spices.

[1.3] Simultaneously, English explorers sought a northern sea route to the wealth of China and India, attempting to discover the elusive **'North-West Passage'** around North America. Martin Frobisher led three expeditions between 1576 and 1578, while John Davis made three voyages in the 1580s. Though they failed to reach Asia, their daring arctic navigations mapped uncharted northern waters and ignited an insatiable English appetite for global maritime expansion.

PRIMARY RECORD SCIENTIFIC NAVIGATIONAL TREATISE 1569

Source A: Gerardus Mercator's World Chart Introduction

> *"In this chart, we have spread out the surface of the globe upon a plane in such a manner that the degrees of latitude increase towards the poles in the same proportion as the degrees of longitude... By this means, the mariner may lay his ruler upon his chart from port to port, and it shall show him the constant compass bearing that he must sail, without the perilous error of curved rhumb lines."*

Flemish cartographer Gerardus Mercator's explanation of his groundbreaking projection, which rendered lines of latitude and longitude at right angles so that straight lines on the chart represented lines of constant compass bearing.

Hinge Question: *How did Mercator's projection map transform ocean navigation from perilous guesswork into an accurate, predictable mathematical science for Elizabethan mariners?*

SECTION 2 THE NAVIGATIONAL REVOLUTION: ASTROLABES, QUADRANTS & MERCATOR MAPS

[2.1] These ambitious oceanic voyages were made possible by a revolutionary scientific transformation in maritime navigation and ship design. Medieval mariners had navigated by dead reckoning—relying on coastal landmarks, lead lines, and guesswork. In the sixteenth century, mathematics and astronomy transformed navigation into a precise science. Navigators utilized the **astrolabe, quadrant, and cross-staff** to measure the exact angular altitude of the sun at midday or the Pole Star at night, enabling them to calculate their latitude at sea with remarkable accuracy.

[2.2] Navigational charting took an enormous leap forward in 1569 when Flemish geographer **Gerardus Mercator** introduced his revolutionary projection map. The Mercator map represented curved lines of longitude and latitude as straight, parallel lines intersecting at right angles. For the first time, mariners could draw a straight line between two ports on a chart and steer a single constant compass bearing (a rhumb line) across thousands of miles of open ocean.

[2.3] Concurrently, English shipbuilding was revolutionized under the direction of Sir John Hawkins, Treasurer of the Navy. Hawkins championed the **'race-built' galleon**: warships designed with longer, sleeker keels, lower forecastles, and lateen-rigged mizzen sails that allowed ships to tack closer into the wind. Faster, more agile, and riding lower in the water than top-heavy Spanish vessels, these ships were engineered specifically to survive stormy Atlantic weather while carrying heavy culverin broadside batteries.

PRIMARY RECORD CONTEMPORARY LONDON HISTORICAL CHRONICLE April 1581

Source B: Chronicler John Stow on Drake's Deptford Knighting

> *"On the fourth day of April, Her Majesty did dine on board the ship of Master Francis Drake, lying at Deptford upon the Thames... After dinner, Her Majesty took a sword and conferred the honour of knighthood upon him, rewarding his courage in sailing round the earthly globe. And she did command that his ship should be preserved in perpetual memory of his worthy service, to the great honour of our nation."*

Description of Queen Elizabeth boarding the Golden Hind at Deptford on 4 April 1581 to dine with Francis Drake and confer upon him the honour of knighthood, ordering his ship to be preserved as a national monument to English naval valour.

Hinge Question: *Why was Elizabeth's public knighting of Drake aboard the Golden Hind viewed across Europe as an open declaration of England's ambition to become an oceanic superpower?*

CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY • SPECIFICATION TERMS

KT 3.3 GLOSSARY

JOINT-STOCK COMPANY
Commercial enterprise where investors pool capital, share risks, and receive dividends from trade.

ASTROLABE
Navigational brass instrument used by mariners to calculate latitude by measuring the angle of stars.

MERCATOR PROJECTION
Map projection representing constant compass bearings as straight lines, revolutionising ocean voyages.

NOVA ALBION
'New England'—the Californian territory claimed for Queen Elizabeth by Sir Francis Drake in June 1579.

KT 3.3 ENQUIRY STUDY DISCIPLINARY ANALYSIS

Exploration and Voyages of Discovery, 1558–1588 (Continued)

SECTION 3 THE GOLDEN HIND'S EPIC JOURNEY: SACKING THE SPANISH PACIFIC, 1577–79

[3.1] The supreme pinnacle of Elizabethan oceanic exploration was Sir Francis Drake's historic global circumnavigation between 1577 and 1580. In December 1577, Drake sailed from Plymouth with five small ships and 164 men. While officially described as an expedition to establish trade in the Nile basin, Drake carried secret instructions signed by Queen Elizabeth: to navigate the treacherous **Strait of Magellan**, enter the Pacific Ocean, and strike the undefended colonial settlements of the Spanish Empire.

[3.2] After surviving ferocious storms, ship losses, and executing a mutinous gentleman (Thomas Doughty) in South America, Drake emerged into the Pacific in 1578 aboard his sole surviving flagship, the ***Golden Hind***. Spain had never fortified its Pacific settlements in Chile and Peru because they believed no foreign vessel could survive the passage around Cape Horn. Operating with complete surprise, Drake plundered Spanish harbours at Valparaíso and Callao, seizing bullion and navigational charts.

[3.3] In March 1579, off the coast of Ecuador, Drake achieved the greatest privateering haul in naval history: he intercepted the unarmed Spanish treasure galleon *Nuestra Señora de la Concepción* (the ***Cacafuego***). Drake transferred **26 tons of silver bullion**, 80 pounds of gold, and 13 chests of minted coin into the hold of the *Golden Hind*, delivering an unimaginable fortune back to England.

KEY HISTORICAL FIGURE 1532–1595



Sir John Hawkins

NAVAL COMMANDER, SHIPBUILDER & TREASURER OF THE NAVY

Pioneered early transatlantic triangular trade voyages and completely rebuilt the royal navy as Treasurer from 1577. His innovative 'race-built' galleons provided England with the naval agility required to defeat the Spanish Armada.

DECISIVE ACTIONS:

- Organised three commercial voyages to West Africa and the Caribbean in the 1560s, trading goods for enslaved Africans.
- Survived the Spanish ambush at San Juan de Ulúa (1568), returning to England committed to modernising naval warfare.
- Redesigned English royal warships with lowered forecastles, longer keels, and four-wheeled truck-mounted culverin batteries.

SECTION 4 NOVA ALBION, THE SPICE ISLANDS & THE DEPTFORD TRIUMPH, 1579–81

[4.1] Knowing Spanish warships would be lying in wait if he attempted to return via Cape Horn, Drake sailed north along the unexplored coast of North America in search of the North-West Passage. In June 1579, having reached modern California, Drake beached the leaking *Golden Hind* near Point Reyes to repair its hull. He met the local Miwok people, erected a commemorative brass plate, and formally claimed the vast territory for Queen Elizabeth, naming it ***Nova Albion*** **('New England')**—the first English territorial claim in North America.

[4.2] Drake then steered west across the uncharted expanse of the Pacific Ocean. Navigating for sixty-eight days without sighting land, he reached the **Moluccas (the Spice Islands)** in modern Indonesia. Drake forged a commercial alliance with the Sultan of Ternate, who was at war with the Portuguese, and loaded six tons of valuable cloves into his ballast. Navigating the treacherous reefs of Java, the Indian Ocean, and rounding the Cape of Good Hope, Drake sailed back into Plymouth Sound in **September 1580** after a 36,000-mile voyage.

[4.3] Drake became the first Englishman to circumnavigate the globe and only the second commander in human history to complete the voyage alive. The expedition yielded an astronomical **£400,000 in plunder**, providing investors with a staggering 4,700% return and clearing Elizabeth's foreign debts. On 4 April 1581, Elizabeth boarded the *Golden Hind* at Deptford and publicly knighted Drake, shattering Spain's monopoly of the oceans and heralding England's emergence as an imperial naval superpower.

CORE STRATEGIC MECHANISM IMPERIAL EXPANSION • 1579

Nova Albion: The First English Claim in North America

In June 1579, during his global circumnavigation, Francis Drake sailed the *Golden Hind* onto the coast of modern-day California:

- **Sovereignty Proclaimed:** Drake beached his ship near Point Reyes to caulk leaking seams, met the local Miwok people, and claimed the vast territory for Queen Elizabeth, naming it *Nova Albion* ('New England').
- **The Brass Plate:** Drake nailed a brass plate to a wooden post inscribed with the date, Elizabeth's name, and a silver sixpence displaying the Queen's portrait as formal legal notice of English possession.
- **Challenging the Papacy:** By claiming land bordering the Pacific, Drake directly rejected the 1494 Papal Bull *Inter Caetera* granting the entire Americas to Spain and Portugal.

Strategic Legacy: Nova Albion established the ideological precedent that Protestant England had a divine right to settle North American lands unoccupied by European Christian princes.

KEY CHRONOLOGY • FOUR CAUSAL TURNING POINTS KT 3.3 SEQUENCE

1569 • Mercator Projection Map
Gerardus Mercator introduces grid projection allowing mariners to navigate along straight compass courses.

1577–80 • Drake's Global Circumnavigation
Golden Hind plunders Spanish Pacific settlements; claims Nova Albion; returns with £400,000 treasure.

Mar 1579 • Capture of the *Cacafuego*
Drake captures Spanish treasure galleon with 26 tons of silver bullion, financing English Crown operations.

4 Apr 1581 • Drake Knighted at Deptford
Queen Elizabeth knights Drake aboard Golden Hind, asserting English oceanic maritime supremacy.

EXAM STRATEGY • EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (OPTION B4) Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins]

Exam Challenge: Explain why Drake circumnavigated the globe in 1577–1580. [12 marks]

Specification Stimulus: (1) Attacking Spanish colonies • (2) Exploring new trade routes • *Construct 3 PEEL paragraphs using precise factual evidence.* GRADE 9 STANDARD

ENQUIRY 4 1HI0/B4 • KEY TOPIC 3.4

Raleigh and the Colonisation of Virginia, 1584–1590

Historical Enquiry: Why did Walter Raleigh's ambitious attempts to establish an English colony on Roanoke Island end in catastrophic failure and the mystery of the 'Lost Colony'?

SECTION 1 RALEIGH'S IMPERIAL VISION & THE 1584 RECONNAISSANCE

[1.1] In the 1580s, English imperial ambitions coalesced around **Sir Walter Raleigh**, a brilliant, dashing Devon courtier, soldier, and royal favourite. Raleigh recognized that establishing permanent agricultural and trading colonies in North America was essential for England's national survival. An American empire would provide forward naval bases to launch privateering strikes against Spanish silver fleets, create lucrative export markets for English wool, supply vital timber, pitch, and hemp to free England from Baltic dependency, and plant a Protestant bulwark against Spanish Catholic expansion.

[1.2] In March 1584, Queen Elizabeth granted Raleigh an exclusive **royal patent** conferring sovereign rights to explore, settle, and govern any 'remote, heathen and barbarous lands' not possessed by Christian monarchs. In April 1584, Raleigh financed a reconnaissance expedition commanded by Philip Amadas and Arthur Barlowe. The captains explored the Outer Banks of North Carolina, discovering Roanoke Island.

[1.3] Barlowe returned with glowing reports, describing the land as fertile, paradise-like, and inhabited by gentle natives. Barlowe brought back two Algonquian Indians–**Manteo and Wanchese**–who learned English and assisted mathematician Thomas Harriot in compiling a bilingual dictionary. Delighted by the expedition's success, Raleigh named the entire territory **'Virginia'** in honour of Elizabeth, the Virgin Queen, and was knighted by the monarch in 1585.

PRIMARY RECORD | OFFICIAL FIRST VOYAGE EXPLORATION REPORT | September 1584

Source A: Arthur Barlowe's Reconnaissance Report to Raleigh

> *"The soil is the most plentiful, sweet, fruitful and wholesome of all the world... We found the people most gentle, loving, and faithful, void of all guile and treason, and such as lived after the manner of the Golden Age. The woods are laden with grapes in such abundance that the very surge of the sea overflowed with them, and cedars taller than any in Bohemia."*

Report submitted by Captain Arthur Barlowe following his survey of the Outer Banks of North Carolina, describing the soil as the most plentiful in the world and the indigenous Secotan people as gentle, loving, and faithful.

Hinge Question: *How did Barlowe's glowing, romanticized account of North America contribute directly to the disastrous under-preparation and subsequent collapse of the 1585 Roanoke colony?*

SECTION 2 THE 1585 ROANOKE OUTPOST: RALPH LANE & THE SECOTAN CLASH

[2.1] In April 1585, Raleigh dispatched England's first colonisation expedition: seven ships carrying **108 male settlers** under the naval command of Sir Richard Grenville, with military officer **Ralph Lane** appointed governor. However, the enterprise was crippled by catastrophic misfortune before the colonists even landed: the expedition's flagship, the ***Tiger***, ran aground on a sandbar off Ocracoke Inlet, flooding its hold and destroying virtually all the colonists' seed wheat and food provisions.

[2.2] The composition of the colony was fatally flawed. The expedition comprised wealthy 'gentlemen' who refused manual agricultural labour, and discharged mercenary soldiers who were accustomed to violence but possessed no farming or fishing skills. Grenville returned to England to procure fresh supplies, leaving Lane to establish a fortified outpost on Roanoke Island.

[2.3] Lane governed with heavy-handed military brutality. When a small silver cup went missing, English soldiers burned down an entire indigenous Secotan village. Relations collapsed completely when the Secotan chief, **Wingina**, grew weary of feeding the helpless colonists and prepared to drive them away. Lane launched a pre-emptive raid, assassinating Wingina. Facing imminent starvation and surrounded by hostile tribes, the colonists abandoned Roanoke in June 1586, taking passage home on Sir Francis Drake's fleet, which arrived unexpectedly after raiding the Caribbean.

PRIMARY RECORD | EYEWITNESS COLONY RELIEVING EXPEDITION JOURNAL | 17 August 1590

Source B: Governor John White's Journal on Returning to Roanoke

> *"We found the houses taken down, and the place very strongly enclosed with a high palisade of great trees, very fort-like. And upon one of the chief trees at the entrance, in fair capital letters, was graven CROATOAN, without any cross or sign of distress... We sought along the sandy shore for my daughter and granddaughter Virginia, but found no sign of any Christian living."*

John White's eyewitness record of walking through the deserted Roanoke settlement in 1590, finding the houses dismantled, rusty iron cannon lying about, and the single word 'CROATOAN' carved into a wooden palisade post without a cross of distress.

Hinge Question: *What does the absence of an engraved cross of distress alongside the word 'CROATOAN' suggest about the circumstances under which the 117 English colonists abandoned their settlement?*

CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY • SPECIFICATION TERMS

KT 3.4 GLOSSARY

ROYAL PATENT
A formal royal charter granting an individual exclusive legal rights to explore, govern, and trade in a territory.

SECOTAN TRIBE
Algonquian-speaking Native Americans inhabiting the Roanoke region, initially friendly but alienated by English brutality.

LOST COLONY
The 1587 settlement of 117 English men, women, and children that vanished mysteriously from Roanoke Island by 1590.

CASH CROP
Agricultural produce grown exclusively for commercial sale and export profit, notably Virginia tobacco.

KT 3.4 ENQUIRY STUDY DISCIPLINARY ANALYSIS

Raleigh and the Colonisation of Virginia, 1584–1590 (Continued)

SECTION 3 THE 1587 SETTLEMENT: FAMILIES, VIRGINIA DARE & THE IMPENDING STORM

[3.1] Undeterred by Lane's failure, Raleigh organized a second colonisation expedition in 1587, led by artist and cartographer **John White**. Crucially, Raleigh rectified the demographic errors of the first attempt: this second colony was planned as a permanent agrarian community, comprising **117 settlers–including 89 men, 17 women, and 11 children**–who were promised 500 acres of land each. Manteo was baptized and named 'Lord of Roanoke'.

[3.2] In August 1587, the colony celebrated a historic milestone: John White's daughter Eleanor Dare gave birth to **Virginia Dare**, the first child born of English Christian parents in North America. However, the settlers faced immediate hardship: they had arrived too late in the agricultural season to plant crops, and the local Secotan remained vengeful following Wingina's murder.

[3.3] Recognizing that the colony could not survive the winter without emergency food and farming implements, the settlers pleaded with Governor White to return to England. White reluctantly set sail in late August 1587, leaving behind his daughter Eleanor, infant granddaughter Virginia, and 115 settlers with strict instructions that if they moved location, they were to carve their destination onto a tree; if forced to abandon the site in distress, they were to carve an engraved cross above the name.

KEY HISTORICAL FIGURE 1554–1618



Sir Walter Raleigh

COURTIER, EXPLORER, AUTHOR & COLONISATION SPONSOR

Visionary sponsor of English colonisation in North America. Granted a royal patent by Elizabeth in 1584, he planned and financed the pioneering expeditions to Roanoke Island, popularising tobacco and the concept of an English overseas empire.

DECISIVE ACTIONS:

- Secured a six-year royal patent in 1584 granting exclusive rights to settle lands in North America not held by Christians.
- Financed the 1584 reconnaissance voyage, naming the territory 'Virginia' in tribute to Elizabeth, the Virgin Queen.
- Organised the 1585 military outpost under Ralph Lane and the 1587 permanent family settlement under Governor John White.

SECTION 4 THE 1588 ARMADA EMBARGO & THE TRAGEDY OF THE "LOST COLONY", 1588–90

[4.1] When John White reached London in November 1587, England was gripped by total emergency. King Philip II was mobilizing the Spanish Armada, and Queen Elizabeth declared an immediate embargo requisitioning every seaworthy ocean vessel for national naval defence. White was trapped in England, unable to organize a relief fleet while his family and settlers waited in the American wilderness.

[4.2] For nearly three agonizing years, Roanoke remained completely isolated from the European world. It was not until **August 1590**, two years after the Armada's defeat, that White was finally able to secure passage on a privateering vessel back to the Outer Banks. Stepping ashore on Roanoke Island on 17 August 1590, White walked into an eerie silence.

[4.3] The settlement was completely deserted. The houses had been dismantled, grass grew in the pathways, and heavy iron cannons lay abandoned in the sand. On a prominent wooden palisade post at the entrance, White found the letters **'CROATOAN'** deeply carved, while on a tree near the shore the letters **'CRO'** were found. Crucially, there was no carved cross of distress. Before White could sail to nearby Croatoan Island (where Manteo's friendly tribe lived), a ferocious hurricane broke their anchor cables and mutinous sailors forced White to return to England. The fate of the 117 colonists remains one of history's greatest unsolved mysteries. Despite total failure, Raleigh's Roanoke expeditions laid the vital ideological, financial, and navigational foundations for the permanent founding of Jamestown in 1607.

CORE STRATEGIC MECHANISM COLONIAL FAILURE • 1585–1590

The Logistical Anatomy of the Roanoke Failure

The collapse of Raleigh's colonial ventures on Roanoke Island resulted from five compounding structural errors:

- **Loss of Supplies:** The flagship *Tiger* ran aground on a sandbar in 1585, flooding the hold and destroying virtually all the colonists' seed grain and food provisions.
- **Inappropriate Personnel:** The 1585 expedition comprised wealthy gentlemen who refused manual labor and discharged soldiers who used violence instead of farming or fishing.
- **Indigenous Hostility:** Ralph Lane burned an entire Secotan village over a stolen silver cup and assassinated Chief Wingina, destroying all local food cooperation.
- **Armada Interruption:** The 1587 settlement under John White was starved of relief supplies for three years because Elizabeth banned all ocean-going ships for defence against the Armada.

Strategic Legacy: Despite total operational collapse, Roanoke provided indispensable lessons in funding, diplomacy, and logistics that ensured the successful founding of Jamestown in 1607.

KEY CHRONOLOGY • FOUR CAUSAL TURNING POINTS KT 3.4 SEQUENCE

Mar 1584 • Raleigh Granted Royal Patent
Elizabeth grants Raleigh 6-year exclusive patent to discover and settle non-Christian lands in the New World.

Jul 1585 • Lane Outpost at Roanoke
Flagship Tiger runs aground, spoiling seeds; Ralph Lane attacks Secotan village; colonists evacuated by Drake.

Jul 1587 • White's Family Settlement
Governor John White lands 117 men, women, and children at Roanoke; Virginia Dare born as first English child.

Aug 1590 • The Lost Colony & CROATOAN
White returns after 3-year Armada delay; settlement deserted; single word CROATOAN carved on palisade.

EXAM STRATEGY • EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (OPTION B4) Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

Exam Challenge: "The lack of supplies was the main reason for the failure of the Roanoke colony in 1585." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

Specification Stimulus: (1) Relations with Native Americans • (2) The damage to the Tiger • *Construct 3 PEEL paragraphs using precise factual evidence.* GRADE 9 STANDARD

SYNOPTIC OVERVIEW KEY TOPIC 3 MASTER SYNTHESIS • 1558–1588

Key Topic 3: Thematic Synoptic Matrix & Historiographical Debate

Historical Assessment: Evaluating domestic social polarisation, educational humanism, poor relief legislation, and overseas colonial ventures.

THEMATIC COMPARATIVE MATRIX • CORE SPECIFICATION THEMES **1558 BASELINE VS. 1588 REALITY**

THEMATIC DIMENSION	THE BASELINE IN 1558	ELIZABETHAN POLICY & TRANSFORMATION	THE BALANCE SHEET BY 1588
1. Education & Literacy	Limited monastic schooling; high illiteracy; education reserved strictly for churchmen and aristocracy.	72 grammar schools founded; humanist Latin curriculum; petty schools and Inns of Court expansion.	Literate 'middling sort' supplied royal administration; but gender and class divides remained rigid.
2. Popular & Elite Culture	Folk mystery plays in inn-yards; brutal folk football and noble field hunting; Catholic church calendar.	Burbage built *The Theatre* (1576); rise of commercial Bankside playhouses; Shakespeare and Marlowe.	Secular commercial theatre united classes; but provoked bitter Puritan moral hostility.
3. Rural Economy & Enclosure	Traditional open-field strip farming; customary tenancy; self-sufficient subsistence agriculture.	Landlords converted arable land to sheep pasture; enclosed common waste; imposed rack-renting.	Wool profits enriched gentry; but caused rural unemployment, peasant evictions, and food inflation.
4. Poverty & Vagrancy Laws	Reliance on voluntary alms and monastic charity; indiscriminate corporal punishment of beggars.	Distinguished Impotent from Idle Poor; 1572 ear boring & poor rates; 1576 Houses of Correction (Bridewells).	Established permanent principle of compulsory state welfare and municipal employment relief.
5. Global Trade & Navigation	Complete dependence on Antwerp cloth market; coastal navigation; reliance on foreign merchant ships.	Joint-stock companies (Muscovy, Levant); astrolabes, Mercator map (1569); Drake circumnavigation (1577–80).	Broke Spanish trade monopoly; £400k Cacafuego haul; proved English ocean-going mastery.
6. American Colonisation	Zero English overseas empire; Papal Treaty of Tordesillas divided Americas between Spain and Portugal.	Raleigh royal patent (1584); 1585 Lane military outpost; 1587 John White family settlement on Roanoke.	Roanoke collapsed into the 'Lost Colony'; but established blueprint for successful 1607 Jamestown.

THE ELIZABETHAN SOCIAL HIERARCHY, POOR LAW STATUTES & EXPLORATION MATRIX (1572–1601) **SOCIAL ORDER, POOR RELIEF & COLONIAL VENTURES**

SOCIAL RANK / STATUTE / VENTURE	SOCIO-ECONOMIC POSITION & LEGAL STATUS	KEY CHARACTERISTICS, STATUTES & MECHANISMS	HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE & IMPACT ON STABILITY
1. Nobility & Gentry (Elite)	Titled peers, knights, squires, gentlemen (~2% of pop.); held vast landed estates and royal offices.	Financed country prodigy houses (Hardwick Hall); enriched by enclosure and wool; served as unpaid JPs.	**Administered local justice, poor relief, and militia levies; maintained order without a standing army.**
2. 'Middling Sort' (Merchants & Yeomen)	Yeoman farmers, tenant farmers, urban merchants, lawyers, and master craftsmen.	Educated in 72 new grammar schools; literate in Latin; invested in joint-stock ventures (Muscovy, Levant).	**Drove commercial capitalism, global trade, and parish governance; bridged elite and labouring poor.**
3. The Impotent Poor (Deserving)	Aged, sick, lame, orphans, and widows physically incapable of work through no fault of their own.	1572 Vagabonds Act instituted compulsory weekly parish poor rates; 1597/1601 codified overseers and almshouses.	**Pioneered statutory state welfare; established legal principle that society must care for the vulnerable.**
4. The Idle Poor (Able-Bodied)	Unemployed labourers, evicted peasants, demobilised soldiers roaming as masterless vagrants.	1572 Act: whipped & bored through ear; 1576 Act created Bridewell Houses of Correction for forced work.	**Contained fears of social rebellion; combined brutal physical deterrence with corrective employment.**
5. Colonial Ventures & Trade	Privateers (Drake), courtiers (Raleigh), and speculative colonist parties (Roanoke 1585/1587).	Royal patents; Mercator projection; joint-stock funding; 1585 Lane military post & 1587 White family colony.	**Despite Roanoke's collapse ('Lost Colony'), broke Spanish monopoly and established blueprint for Jamestown (1607).**

THE HISTORIOGRAPHICAL DEBATE • THREE PERSPECTIVES ON ELIZABETHAN SOCIETY & EMPIRE

HISTORICAL SCHOLARSHIP

1. TRADITIONAL WHIG (A.L. ROWSE, 1950):
The Elizabethan era was an incandescent 'Golden Age' of patriotic expansion. Humanist education and the secular theatre unleashed creative genius, while sea dogs like Drake and Raleigh gallantly planted the seeds of global British liberty and imperial commerce.

2. SOCIAL REVISIONIST (KEITH WRIGHTSON, 1982):
The 'Golden Age' masked profound social polarisation. Population boom and enclosure enriched the landed gentry and 'middling sort' while driving the bottom third of the population into wretched rural vagrancy and starvation, managed by savage ear boring.

3. POST-REVISIONIST IMPERIAL (NICHOLAS CANNY, 2001):
Roanoke and Virginia were not romantic adventures but early experiments in violent colonial subjugation directly linked to Tudor plantations in Ireland. Settlers treated indigenous populations with brutal militarism (Wingina's murder), guaranteeing their own operational doom.

Hinge Question for Class Discussion: *Was Elizabethan England genuinely a 'Golden Age' of humanist culture and global exploration, or was it a deeply unequal society defined by rural destitution and brutal social control?*

COMPARATIVE POLICY SUCCESS EVALUATION • 1558–1588 **CRITERIA-LED VERDICT**

1. EDUCATION: HIGH
72 grammar schools and university expansion fostered a skilled, loyal 'middling sort' capable of managing Tudor law and government.

2. POOR LAWS: MODERATE
Acts of 1572 and 1576 pioneered compulsory taxation and rehabilitation; but failed to halt structural poverty driven by harvest failures.

3. OCEANIC EXPLORATION: HIGH
Scientific navigation, joint-stock companies, and Drake's circumnavigation broke Iberian monopoly and laid foundations of naval empire.

4. COLONISATION: FAILURE
Both 1585 and 1587 Roanoke ventures collapsed due to food losses, indigenous hostility, and Armada delays; zero permanent settlers by 1590.

SYNOPTIC VERDICT • DOMESTIC TRANSFORMATION AND THE EMBRYONIC EMPIRE

Between 1558 and 1588, Elizabethan England underwent profound domestic and global transformation. The expansion of humanist grammar schools and the emergence of the commercial playhouse fostered a dynamic, literate national culture that democratized entertainment across social ranks. Yet this flourishing Renaissance coincided with severe agrarian crisis: population boom, harvest failure, and sheep enclosure produced mass vagrancy that forced the state to construct Europe's first statutory welfare system. Abroad, bold merchant joint-stock enterprises and Drake's global circumnavigation shattered Iberian maritime supremacy. While Walter Raleigh's attempts to colonize Virginia ended in the tragic enigma of the 'Lost Colony', the financial, logistical, and maritime techniques perfected under Elizabeth directly enabled the permanent birth of the British Empire in the seventeenth century.

EXAM MASTERCLASS EDEXCEL PAPER 2 OPTION B4 • 1HI0/B4

Edexcel Paper 2: Examination Strategy & Exemplar Model Answers

Official Exam Blueprint: Deconstructing Question 1(a) & 1(b) Features [4m], Question 2 Causation [12m], and Question 3 Evaluative Essay [16m + 4 SPaG].

KEY CHRONOLOGY: EIGHT CAUSAL TURNING POINTS (1558–1590)

SPECIFICATION EVIDENCE RECALL

1567 • Harman's Caveat
Pamphlet exposes vagrant 'Counterfeit Cranks'; stokes anti-vagrant hysteria.

1569 • Mercator Projection
Map projection revolutionises ocean navigation with straight compass lines.

1572 • Vagabonds Act
Severe corporal penalties (ear boring) combined with mandatory weekly poor rates.

1576 • The Theatre Built
Burbage builds first commercial playhouse; 1576 Poor Act creates Bridewells.

1577–80 • Circumnavigation
Drake navigates globe on *Golden Hind*; claims Nova Albion; returns with £400k.

1584 • Virginia Patent
Raleigh granted royal patent; Amadas & Barlowe reconnaissance surveys Roanoke.

1585–86 • Ralph Lane's Colony
Tiger grounding ruins food; Lane assassinates Wingina; colonists evacuate with Drake.

Aug 1590 • The Lost Colony
White returns after Armada embargo; finds Roanoke deserted with 'CROATOAN'.

QUESTION 1(A) & 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE OF... [2 MARKS EACH • 4 MARKS TOTAL • 6 MINS]

Formula: 1 Mark Valid Feature + 1 Mark Supporting Detail (0 Explanation/Consequences)

Q1(a): Describe one feature of Elizabethan grammar schools. [2 marks]
Model Answer: One feature was the academic curriculum focused almost exclusively on classical Latin grammar, Greek, and rhetoric. *[1 mark for valid feature]* Pupils attended from 6:00 am to 5:30 pm six days a week, memorizing Latin texts from authors such as Cicero and Virgil under the threat of corporal punishment with the birch rod. *[1 mark for supporting historical detail]*

Q1(b): Describe one feature of the 1572 Vagabonds Act. [2 marks]
Model Answer: One feature was the introduction of a compulsory weekly poor rate collected by local Justices of the Peace. *[1 mark for valid feature]* This statutory tax made property owners legally responsible for funding pensions to support the impotent poor (the aged, sick, and disabled), imprisoning those who refused to pay. *[1 mark for supporting historical detail]*

Examiner Warning: Notice that Edexcel Paper 2 strictly splits Question 1 into Q1(a) [2m] and Q1(b) [2m]. Keep answers concise: state the feature, provide one precise factual detail/date/statistic, and stop immediately. Never write explanations or consequences!

QUESTION 2: EXPLAIN WHY... [12 MARKS • 18 MINUTES]

Formula: 3 Full PEEL Paragraphs (2 Stimulus + 1 Own Knowledge) + Explicit Causal Connectives

Exam Prompt: Explain why poverty and vagrancy increased in Elizabethan England between 1558 and 1588. You may use: (1) Enclosure of land, (2) Population growth. [12 marks]

PEEL Paragraph 1 (Agrarian Enclosure & Sheep Pasture): One major reason poverty and vagrancy soared was the spread of agricultural enclosure and conversion of arable land to sheep pasture. Traditional open-field arable farming had sustained dozens of peasant families per village, but rising wool prices incentivized landlords to fence off common land and convert fields into pastures, where a single shepherd could tend 2,000 sheep. Furthermore, landlords engaged in rack-renting, drastically hiking rents to evict customary tenants. *Consequently,* hundreds of tenant families were evicted from their ancestral land with no means of subsistence, forcing them to wander the highways as homeless vagabonds in search of work.

PEEL Paragraph 2 (Demographic Growth & Food Price Inflation): Furthermore, the crisis was driven by explosive population growth across sixteenth-century England. The national population increased by over 35%, expanding from 2.8 million in 1558 to over 4 million by the end of the reign. Because agricultural output failed to keep pace with demographic demand, food supplies grew scarce, causing grain prices to double. *As a direct result,* ordinary labourers suffered a catastrophic drop in real wages, spending up to 80% of their earnings merely on bread. When poor harvests struck in the 1570s and 1580s, working families who could previously survive were plunged into absolute destitution.

PEEL Paragraph 3 (Own Knowledge: Collapse of the Antwerp Cloth Trade): Crucially, poverty was dramatically exacerbated by the sudden collapse of England's primary overseas export market: the Antwerp cloth trade. English cloth accounted for over 75% of national exports, but when war erupted in the Spanish Netherlands and Philip II placed trade embargoes on English goods in the 1560s, the Antwerp exchange ground to a halt. *Therefore,* thousands of domestic cloth workers, spinners, and weavers in East Anglia and the West Country lost their employment overnight; unable to find agricultural work due to enclosure, they were forced into urban vagrancy, swelling the slums of London.

Examiner Causation Strategy (Level 4): Contrast long-term demographic and agrarian changes (enclosure, population boom) with the immediate catalytic shock of the Antwerp trade embargoes. Candidates must explicitly link causes together. **12/12 CRITERIA**

QUESTION 3: EVALUATIVE ESSAY [16 MARKS + 4 SPAG • 25 MINUTES]

Level 4 Standard: 3 Balanced Factors + Criteria-Led Sustained Judgement

Exam Prompt: "The lack of food supplies was the main reason for the failure of the Virginia colonies in the 1580s." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. You may use: (1) The grounding of the Tiger (1585), (2) Relations with Native Americans (Wingina). [16 marks + 4 SPaG]

FACTOR 1: FOOD SUPPLIES (AGREE)
Grounding of the flagship *Tiger* in 1585 ruined almost all seed grain and provisions; colonists arrived too late in season to plant crops in 1587, creating total dependency on relief.

FACTOR 2: INDIGENOUS CONFLICT (COUNTER)
Lane's heavy-handed military brutality (burning a Secotan village over a stolen cup) and assassination of Chief Wingina turned local tribes hostile, cutting off all trade and food assistance.

FACTOR 3: POOR PERSONNEL & ARMADA DELAY (COUNTER)
Gentlemen refused manual labour; soldiers used violence instead of fishing; 1588 Armada crisis caused a 3-year shipping embargo, stranding the 1587 settlers without relief.

EXEMPLAR LEVEL 4 CONCLUSION (CRITERIA-LED SUSTAINED JUDGEMENT):
"In conclusion, while the catastrophic loss of food supplies caused by the grounding of the Tiger was the immediate physical catalyst for starvation, poor leadership and the breakdown of indigenous relations were the fundamental causes of the Virginia colonies' failure. When assessing causality by the criterion of reversibility, the lack of food was only fatal because the colonists possessed neither the skills to forage for themselves nor the diplomatic goodwill to secure sustenance from the Secotan tribe. Ralph Lane's fatal decision to burn a native village over a stolen cup and assassinate Chief Wingina destroyed any possibility of indigenous agricultural support. Furthermore, the colony's demographic composition—dominated by aristocratic gentlemen who refused manual labour and violent soldiers unsuited to farming—ensured that the 1585 settlement was structurally incapable of self-sufficiency. In 1587, this operational fragility was sealed by the unexpected 1588 Spanish Armada crisis, which prevented John White from returning with relief ships for three critical years. Therefore, food shortages triggered the crises, but flawed colonial planning and toxic indigenous relations made disaster inevitable."

SPaG Masterclass (+4 Marks): Spell technical terms accurately (*enclosure, humanism, rack-renting, Roanoke, Croatoan, joint-stock*). Use complex analytical evaluative phrases (*fundamentally, precipitated, structural constraint*). **4/4 SPaG TARGET**

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 EXAMINER MARKING BLUEPRINT & BAND DESCRIPTORS

OPTION B4 • 1HI0/B4

LEVEL 4 (13–16 MARKS)
Criteria-Led Evaluation: Analytical throughout; deploys line-by-line precise factual evidence; sustained judgement weighing root vs catalytic causes.

LEVEL 3 (9–12 MARKS)
Explanatory & Balanced: Explains both stimulus points plus own knowledge; links factors to prompt, but conclusion summarizes rather than synthesizes.

LEVEL 2 (5–8 MARKS)
Descriptive Narrative: Recounts narrative events without explicit analytical focus; unbalanced or lacks independent own knowledge beyond stimulus.

LEVEL 1 (1–4 MARKS)
Basic Statements: Generalized historical assertions with significant inaccuracies; offers simple assertions without supporting factual detail.

Exam Timing Allocation (50 Mins): Q1(a) 3 mins [2m] • Q1(b) 3 mins [2m] • Q2 Causation 18 mins [12m] • Q3 Essay 25 mins [16+4m] • Review 1 min **PEARSON EDEXCEL SPECIFICATION TARGET**

KEY TOPIC 3 CHRONOLOGICAL SEQUENCE • TURNING POINTS (1558–1590)

CAUSAL PROGRESSION

DATE	PIVOTAL EVENT	HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE & CAUSAL CONSEQUENCE
1560s	Expansion of Grammar Schools	72 grammar schools founded under Elizabeth; humanist Latin training fosters the 'middling sort'.
1567	Harman's *Caveat for Cursitors*	Sensationalist taxonomy of vagabond tricks stokes national moral panic over 'idle' rogues.
1568	San Juan de Ulúa Ambush	Spanish attack on Hawkins and Drake shatters maritime truce, opening era of English privateering.
1569	Mercator Projection Published	Flemish cartographer introduces projection enabling straight-line compass navigation across oceans.
1571	Jesus College Oxford Founded	First Protestant college endowed by royal charter to educate Welsh scholars for state service.
1572	The 1572 Vagabonds Act	Enforces ear-boring on rogues while mandating compulsory weekly poor rates collected by JPs.
1576	Burbage Builds *The Theatre*	London's first purpose-built public playhouse opens in Shoreditch, launching commercial drama.
1576	Act for the Relief of the Poor	Towns ordered to provide raw materials for employment and establish Bridewell Houses of Correction.
Jun 1579	Drake Claims *Nova Albion*	Drake lands in California, nails brass plate for Queen Elizabeth; claims first English territory in America.
Sep 1580	Drake Returns on *Golden Hind*	Completes circumnavigation with £400,000 treasure; knighted at Deptford on 4 April 1581.
Mar 1584	Raleigh Granted Virginia Patent	Royal patent authorizes settlement; Amadas & Barlowe survey Outer Banks; territory named 'Virginia'.
1585–1586	Ralph Lane's Roanoke Colony	*Tiger* grounding ruins grain; Lane assassinates Wingina; colonists starve and evacuate with Drake.
18 Aug 1587	Birth of Virginia Dare	First English child born in North America; Governor John White returns to England for supplies.
Aug 1590	Discovery of the 'Lost Colony'	White returns after Armada embargo; finds Roanoke deserted with 'CROATOAN'; colony lost to history.

KEY DISCIPLINARY TERMINOLOGY

- **Humanism:** Renaissance philosophy prioritising classical Latin grammar, rhetoric, and civic responsibility.
- **Grammar Schools:** Fee-paying secondary schools educating boys from the middling sort in Latin, Greek, and debate.
- **Groundlings:** Common theatregoers paying one penny to stand in the open pit of commercial playhouses.
- **Enclosure:** Fencing in communal open fields for sheep pasture, causing rural depopulation and rack-renting.
- **Impotent Poor:** Those physically unable to work (aged, sick, lame), relieved by statutory parish poor rates.
- **Joint-Stock Company:** Business where investors pool capital and share liability, pioneering overseas global trade.
- **Mercator Projection:** 1569 map projection representing lines of constant compass direction as straight lines.
- **Royal Patent:** Official royal charter granting exclusive rights to explore, govern, and trade in a new territory.

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 EXAM FRAMEWORK & MODELS

32 MARKS TOTAL • 50 MINS

Q1(a) & Q1(b): Describe ONE feature of... [2 + 2 = 4 Marks • 6 Mins]
Model: "Describe one feature of the 1572 Vagabonds Act."
Formula: 1 mark valid feature + 1 mark supporting historical detail (0 explanation).

Q2: Explain why... [12 Marks • 18 Mins]
Model: "Explain why poverty and vagrancy increased between 1558 and 1588."
Formula: 3 PEEL paragraphs (2 stimulus + 1 own knowledge) linked with causal connectives.

Q3: Evaluative Essay [16 Marks + 4 SPaG • 25 Mins]
Model: "'Food shortages were the main reason for Roanoke's failure.' How far do you agree?"
Formula: 3 balanced analytical paragraphs + criteria-led sustained conclusion.

ASSESSMENT OBJECTIVE 1 (AO1 • 50%):
Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of key features (grammar schools, enclosure statistics, poor relief statutes, navigational instruments, Roanoke dates).

ASSESSMENT OBJECTIVE 2 (AO2 • 50%):
Explain and analyse historical events using second-order concepts (cause, consequence, change, continuity, and reaching sustained historical judgements).

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL RETRIEVAL HUB **KEY TOPIC 3 KNOWLEDGE QUIZ & FLASHCARDS**

Scan the QR code with any smartphone or tablet camera to launch the interactive, self-marking retrieval bank for Key Topic 3. Test your rapid recall across Grammar Schools, Enclosure & Vagrancy, Poor Laws, Drake's Circumnavigation, and Raleigh's Roanoke colony with instant model answers and scoring.

• 20 Specification Recall Questions • Instant Self-Marking & Explanations • Digital Leitner Flashcard Deck

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